

TOP PHONE PICKS

21 Samsung Galaxy Z Fold 7

Seven generations in, the Galaxy Z Fold 7 is the first that feels "ready." Slimmer, lighter, and more pocketable, it finally behaves like a normal phone when closed. The displays are brighter, the hinge is smoother, and performance is rock-solid. It's still pricey at ₹1,74,999 and charging is slow, but for foldable first-timers, this is Samsung's most refined take yet.



usability, but falls short with an older Snapdragon 8 Gen 3 chip and weak speakers. A near-perfect foldable, just not flawless.

23 Nothing Phone 3a

The Nothing Phone 3a is all about identity. Its transparent back, refined Glyph Interface, and minimal yet feature-rich Nothing OS 3.1 make it stand out in a sea of lookalikes. The Snapdragon 7s Gen 3 isn't the fastest in class, but the cohesive experience with strong cameras, excellent display, clean software, and reliable battery life, makes it one of the most distinctive sub-Rs 25K phones. If you want something that feels fresh without losing practicality, this is it.



a powerhouse for everyday use, with stellar cameras, excellent audio capture, and smooth performance that exceeds most people's needs.

For creators, the improved camera app adds control without third-party workarounds. If you don't care about chasing the very latest, the iPhone 16 remains a fantastic buy especially now at lower prices.

25 Samsung Galaxy Z Flip 7

Foldables may not be rare anymore, but the Galaxy Z Flip 7 proves they can still be exciting. With a larger cover screen, sleeker hinge-free design, brighter displays, and Samsung's 7-year update promise, this is the most refined clamshell yet. Cameras are good but not best-in-class, and battery life is decent, but if you're buying for the vibe, finesse, and everyday usability, the Flip 7 finally nails the formula.

22 Vivo X Fold 5

The Vivo X Fold 5 is the sleekest foldable you can buy today. Just 4.3 mm thin when open and only 217 g, it packs a massive 6,000 mAh battery and two gorgeous LTPO displays. It nails design, battery, camera and



24 Apple iPhone 16

Even with the iPhone 17 out, the iPhone 16 is far from outdated. It's

READ THIS BEFORE SPENDING BIG ON YOUR NEXT SMARTPHONE

When investing in an expensive smartphone, it's important to look beyond flashy features and focus on long-term value. Here are five key things to consider:

- 1. Performance & Processor:** Premium phones should deliver fast, smooth performance for years. Look for the latest flagship processors (like Apple's A-series or Qualcomm's Snapdragon 8 Gen chips) paired with ample RAM. This ensures multitasking, gaming, and demanding apps run effortlessly.
- 2. Display Quality:** The screen is where you'll spend most of your time. High-resolution OLED or AMOLED panels with high refresh rates (120Hz or more) offer sharper visuals, vibrant colors, and smoother scrolling.
- 3. Camera System:** Flagship phones often justify their price with superior cameras. Pay attention to main sensor quality, low-light performance, telephoto and ultra-wide lenses, and video capabilities. Features like optical image stabilization and AI enhancements also matter for consistent shots.
- 4. Battery & Charging:** Expensive phones should easily last a full day of heavy use. Check battery capacity, power efficiency, and fast charging or wireless charging support.
- 5. Software & Ecosystem:** Beyond hardware, long-term software updates and ecosystem benefits (integration with laptops, wearables, and smart devices) add real value to a premium phone, so always keep that in mind.